

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) – Prime Minister’s Scholarship Scheme (PMSS)

1. What is the Prime Minister’s Scholarship Scheme (PMSS)?

PMSS is a scholarship scheme launched under the National Defence Fund to encourage technical and professional education for the wards and widows of personnel of CAPFs, Assam Rifles, and States/UTs Police personnel martyred in Terror/Naxal attacks.

2. Who is eligible to apply under PMSS?

Eligible applicants include:

- Wards/widows of CAPFs & AR personnel who killed in action or died for causes attributable to Government service.
 - Wards of disabled personnel of CAPFs & AR personnel.
 - Wards of personnel in receipt of Gallantry Awards.
 - Wards of retired and serving CAPFs & AR personnel (PBOR).
 - Wards of States/UTs Police personnel martyred in Terror/Naxal attacks.
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3. What is the minimum educational qualification required?

- **New Applicants:** Must have secured at least 60% in the Minimum Entry Qualification (MEQ) such as 10+2, diploma or graduation.
 - **Renewal Applicants:** Must pass each academic year with at least 50% marks.
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4. What is the duration and amount of the scholarship?

- **Duration:** Up to 5 years (based on course duration).
 - **Amount:** ₹3,000/month for girls and ₹2,500/month for boys (paid annually).
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5. Is there a quota for scholarships?

Yes. Each year under fresh category:

- 2,000 scholarships (1,000 for boys and 1,000 for girls) for CAPFs & AR categories.
 - 500 scholarships (250 for boys and 250 for girls) for States/UTs Police category.
- Note: Quotas are not interchangeable between genders.*
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6. What courses are covered under PMSS?

Only the **first professional degree courses** such as BE, B.Tech, MBBS, BDS, BBA, BCA, B.Pharm, B.Sc Nursing etc., recognized by AICTE, UGC, MCI etc. are eligible. Refer to Appendix-I in the guidelines for the full list.

7. Are integrated courses eligible?

Yes, but only the **professional component** of an integrated course is eligible. For dual professional degrees, only the **first professional component** is covered.

8. How can I apply for the scholarship?

Applications must be submitted **online** through the **National Scholarship Portal (NSP)** at www.scholarship.gov.in. Read the full guidelines before applying.

9. Is Aadhaar mandatory?

Yes. Aadhaar or Aadhaar Enrolment ID is **mandatory** for both minor (Can use parent’s Aadhar) and major applicants.

10. What documents are required during application?

- Service certificate (Annexure-A) for serving personnel.
- PPO/Discharge/Death/Disability/Gallantry award certificate (as applicable).
- Bonafide certificate from institution.
- Self-attested MEQ mark sheet.

For States/UTs Police: A certificate confirming martyrdom in Terror/Naxal attack issued by the State Govt.

11. Can I update bank details after application?

The scholarship is paid via **Aadhaar-seeded bank account** using DBT through PFMS.

12. What is the selection criteria for fresh applications?

Selection is based on:

1. Category preference.
 2. Percentage in MEQ.
 3. Age (higher age preferred).
 4. Parent's rank (lower rank preferred).
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13. Can students studying abroad or in unrecognized colleges apply?

No. PMSS is not applicable to students studying abroad or enrolled in institutions not recognized by UGC, AICTE, MCI, or other regulatory bodies.

14. Can a student avail multiple scholarships?

No. Applicants receiving any other scholarship/stipend are **not eligible** for PMSS.

15. What happens if I submit incorrect or false information?

Such applications will be **rejected** and the scholarship will be cancelled and required to **refund** the scholarship amount with interest.

16. Can I apply for PMSS if I am already in the second year of a course?

Yes, if you were admitted directly to the **2nd year via lateral entry** (e.g., after diploma in engineering), you are eligible. But PMSS is not applicable for second-year admission through regular progression.

17. What is the maximum number of children from a family who can avail this scholarship?

Only **two children per family** are eligible to receive the scholarship under PMSS.

18. Is there any age limit to apply for the scholarship?

There is no specific age limit mentioned, but **preference is given to applicants of higher age** during merit-based selection.

19. Can I change my course or college after being selected?

No. Any change of course/college/institute after selection will result in **automatic cancellation** of the scholarship.

20. Can I apply again next year if I missed applying this year?

Yes, but only if you are still in your **first year** and fulfill all eligibility criteria. For **renewal**, a **grace period of one year** is allowed in case of delay in applying.

21. What happens if my application is rejected or marked as defective?

If your application is rejected or marked defective due to any issue, you must correct and resubmit it **before the verification deadline**. If the application is withdrawn, you may reapply within the open window of NSP.

22. How can I track the status of my application?

You can **track the status** using your **NSP registration ID and password** on www.scholarship.gov.in.

23. When will the scholarship amount be credited to my account?

After final verification and merit selection, the amount will be **directly credited** into your **Aadhaar-seeded bank account** through **PFMS**, typically within a few weeks of final processing.

24. Do I need to submit hard copies of documents anywhere?

No. PMSS is a **completely online process**.

25. Can I edit my application after submission?

Once submitted, **no changes** can be made. However, **withdrawal and re-application** is allowed **before Level-2 (Force Nodal Officer) verification**, using the standard withdrawal reasons provided as drop-down menu.

26. Will I receive any official communication upon selection?

Yes. Once you select for the scholarship, a system generated confirmation through text message will be received on registered mobile number.

27. What is the role of the college/institute in my application?

Your college/institute must **verify your application and uploaded documents** online. Unverified applications will not be processed for selection.

28. Will I get a confirmation message after submitting the application?

Yes. A system generated text message will be received on registered mobile number.

29. Can students from private colleges apply?

Yes, provided the college/institute is **approved by UGC/AICTE/MCI** or the relevant government regulatory authority. The course listed in **Appendix-I** of the guidelines.

30. Whom should I contact if I have technical problems while applying?

For technical issues on NSP, you can contact **NSP helpdesk**. For service-related clarifications, contact the respective **CAPFs/AR/State Police nodal officer** (contact details are provided in the guidelines). You can also contact to WARB, MHA on 011-23063111, e-mail id is secywarb-mha@nic.in.
